Community-Based Support Services

For the Interfaith Community

Introduction

It's no secret; the demand for public health and social safety net services is on the rise, while government funding for these programs is in decline. Sadly, while the faith community does its best to care for vulnerable members of its congregation and the local community, increased competition for dwindling funds make it difficult for nonprofit programs to keep pace with rising demand. Overcoming resource constraints, competition and silos is the hallmark of a transformational and collective impact movement called PHIERS.org.

PHIERS is the Public Health Information Exchange and Referral Service (PHIERS). The goal of PHIERS is to promote collaboration between nonprofits in the areas of health, education and social services. By working as partners with nonprofits of all types and making it easy to build upon one another's success, we can increase nonprofit performance, capacity and sustainability.

- **PHIERS.org and its nonprofit members** wish to tailor its evidence-based toolkit for the faith community, with a focus on at risk and immigrant youth, caregiver support and coordinated social services for participating seniors and veterans.
- **Our goal is to coordinate and track improvements** in the health status of participating members, congregations and their surrounding communities.
- **The project will launch in Fall 2015**, and create a holistic community development-based initiative that integrates public health and social services with comprehensive training and support services that promote self-sufficiency
- **Create employment opportunities and recruit, train and hire** health /social workers to help nonprofits migrate from paper to a shared and secure information service that eliminates data silos and make it affordable to coordinate care across settings, which will reduce costs without harming care. We will tailor our services to meet the needs of the local community, while working tirelessly to improve the health status and outcomes for participating congregations.

About PHIERS

- **Our ultimate goal is to** *strengthen* and expand the safety net so we can better serve those with health needs.
- We provide tools, training, staffing and support to strengthen nonprofits and expand the safety net.
- We advocate for resources to expand relationships and increase outcomes for nonprofit organizations.
- Organize and facilitate coordinated interventions that save more than they cost to sustain.
- Function as a person-centered, holistic and expanded care team on behalf of those in need of such support and/or care.

By working together with community organizers and best of breed nonprofits, we have developed an evidence-based approach to inspiring and improving the health status of individuals, congregations; school aged kids and entire communities.

- **PHIERS.org is a network of best-of breed nonprofits** focused on improving the health status of **participating** schools and congregations. One solution makes it easy to connect members to the resources they need in a timely and cost-effective manner, making it easy to provide reliable, timely and tangible relief for veterans, economically disadvantaged and other vulnerable members of society.
- **Our interventions are designed to pay for themselves after the first year** of operation, without increasing taxes, raising the deficit or requiring legislation. Benefits include sponsorship, national recognition and sustainable funding support from public and private sources.

PHIERS.org wishes to help the interfaith community better serve its members and local communities, by connecting beneficiaries and struggling families to the local resources they need to live empowered lives.

- We provide decision support, counseling services and local resources they need to improve access to available resources, in a coordinated and compassionate manner.
- In this way, we help patients make better informed decisions, and become more responsible and effective healthcare consumers and/or caregivers, reducing costs for public health and social safety net services.

Benefits of PHEIRS

- **To the Interfaith Community:** Our Nonprofit Toolkit will help nonprofits improve their positive impact, reach and cost-benefit to society while strengthening and expanding the safety net so we can better care for an aging and increasingly poor, sick and/or vulnerable population.
- **For Local Congregations:** Participating organizations will receive a personalized web-portal connecting their respective congregations to local nonprofits that are committed to improving the options, lives and health statuses of communities served. By working together and monitoring outcomes, the cost benefits to society to far outweigh the cost of status quo thinking.
- **To Local Nonprofits:** By sharing a secure and shared information service, nonprofits can improve coordination of care across settings, improving outcomes and reducing costs without compromising and thereby improving care. In this way we improve nonprofit performance, productivity and cost-benefit to society. Attract multiple performance-based revenue streams.
- **To Government Payers:** Government agencies have overlapping and complimentary responsibilities to consumers of critical public services (health, education, senior and social services, etc.). The Interfaith community can help government agencies achieve alignment around a single patient, in a cost-effective, secure, comprehensive and responsive manner. For example:
    - **Most veterans are baby boomers living with multiple chronic conditions** that must be coordinated to get the best outcomes in the least amount of time for the lowest costs.
    - **There are numerous government-funded safety net programs with overlapping responsibilities** whose beneficiaries will benefit from collaboration with wrap-around, multi-disciplinary service providers.
    - **Holistic care (mind|body|spirit) has been proven to yield the best outcomes for the lowest costs.**

Measurable Results in 5 Simple Steps

- ***Step 1***: Invite faith-based organizations to fill out the survey at ***http://phiers.org/register/***
- ***Step 2:*** PHIERS.org will tailor the toolkit for target audience.
- ***Step 3:*** Coordinate and track interventions according to each congregation's priorities and available resources, in collaboration with local nonprofits
- ***Step 4:*** Monitor outcomes and assess cost-benefits on an organizational, community-based or individual basis.
- ***Step 5:*** Use data to improve performance, impact and outreach efforts while applying for future grants.

Qualifications

- A growing list of nonprofits have partnered with public health and social service providers and PHIERS.org to use a shared information infrastructure to promote continuity of care across settings.
- We have enlisted the support of case managers, transitional care experts, discharge planners and care coordinators to augment existing program to reduce likelihood of future ER visits and readmissions.

Contact Us

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